Bank Danamon

Six thousand call types to 526 — the taxonomy was the transformation

A service catalogue that has grown to six thousand entries is not a catalogue. It is an archaeological record of every request anyone ever made, and no amount of routing, automation or agent training fixes what sits underneath it.

6,000	526	180+	200+	863+	76
call types before	call types after	first-touch resolution types	communication templates	branches served	integration touchpoints

DEPLOYMENT CONTEXT · PUBLICLY AND VENDOR REPORTED

Indonesia's tenth-largest bank by assets, roughly Rp276 trillion consolidated · retail, SME, commercial and enterprise banking · 5,000+ platform users, 6M+ customers

Aditya Singh · Analysis authored for solution and transformation strategy · reference deployment

Vendor and platform names removed. Bank scale is publicly reported; deployment figures are vendor-reported; the taxonomy method is mine.

A six-thousand-entry service catalogue is not a classification system — it is a record of every request ever made, and it makes everything downstream unmeasurable

Situation

A large Indonesian bank serving retail, SME, commercial and enterprise segments across more than eight hundred branches, with a service estate carrying roughly six thousand distinct call types.

Each one had been added for a reason, by someone, at some point.

Complication

At that granularity nothing works. Agents cannot find the right type, so they pick an adjacent one. Reporting is meaningless because volume is spread across dozens of near-duplicates. Routing rules multiply. First-touch resolution cannot be measured, let alone improved, because the same request is recorded four different ways.

And every automation initiative fails, because automation needs a stable definition of what is being automated.

The work

Rebuild the taxonomy from customer intent rather than from system boundaries, collapse to a set an agent can navigate, then define which types resolve at first touch and build the templates and routing to support them.

Everything visible — routing, automation, reporting, first-touch resolution — became possible only after that.

THE NUMBERS THAT MATTER

6,000 → 526	**11×**	**180+**	**200+**	**1**	**0**
call types	reduction in catalogue	first-touch types defined	templates built	definition per intent	automation before this

The pattern worth recognising: service catalogues only grow. Adding a type is easy and locally correct; removing one requires asserting nobody needs it. Left alone for a decade, any service organisation arrives here — and the symptom presented is always poor turnaround, never the catalogue.

Source: Author's analysis

Bank scale is publicly reported and deployment figures are vendor-reported; the taxonomy method and the collapse approach are mine

REPORTED

Deployment context

Bank scale from public sources; deployment figures as reported by the platform vendor.

- ~Rp276 trillion consolidated assets
- Tenth largest Indonesian bank by assets
- 863+ branches in deployment scope
- 5,000+ platform users, 6M+ customers
- 12+ integrated systems, 76 touchpoints
- 1,000+ user concurrency

ANALYSIS & METHOD

My contribution

The taxonomy rebuild method, the collapse approach and the first-touch design, authored for solution and transformation strategy on comparable pursuits.

- Taxonomy rebuild method
- Collapse and merge approach
- First-touch resolution design
- Template and routing model
- Disposition and reporting continuity
- Applied on comparable pursuits

ILLUSTRATIVE

Modelled

The collapse decomposition and effort split illustrate the method. Directional, not measured.

- Collapse decomposition by cause
- Effort split across phases
- First-touch eligibility analysis
- Replace with bank actuals
- Shape is the argument
- Method transfers unchanged

OUT OF SCOPE

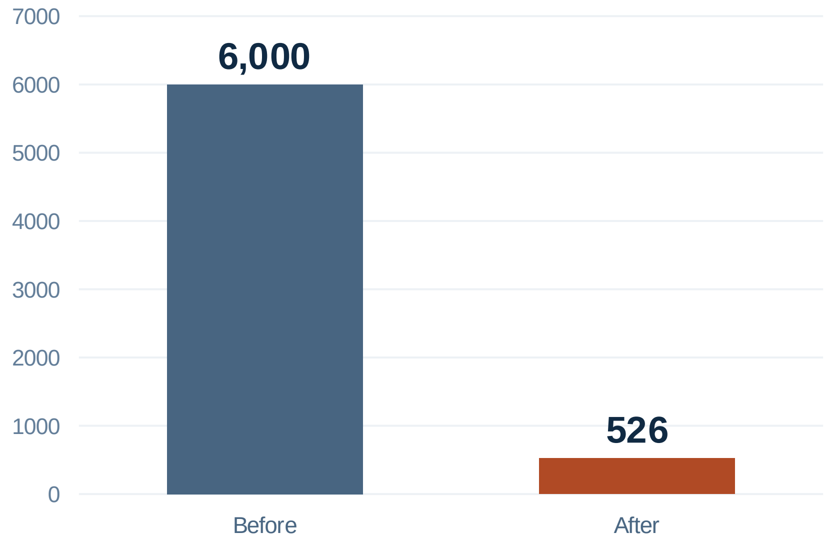
Not claimed

Excluded deliberately.

- Delivery ownership of this programme
- Any role on the implementation team
- Bank commercial outcomes
- Any customer or case data
- Independently audited results
- Any confidential document

Source: Public bank figures and vendor-reported deployment figures (context) · author's delivery record and method (ownership)

Six thousand entries were not six thousand services — most were duplicates, system artefacts or one-off additions that nobody ever removed



Distinct service call types in the catalogue, before and after — reported figures

180+
first-touch resolution types defined

200+
communication templates built

76
integration touchpoints in scope

12+
systems integrated behind the catalogue

How the catalogue got there

- Types named after the fulfilling system, so one customer intent split across four back-end owners became four entries.
- Every product launch added its own set rather than extending an existing one.
- Branch and channel teams added local variants because they could not find the existing entry.
- Nothing was ever retired, because retiring requires proving nobody uses it.

What an eleven-fold reduction actually says

The collapse was not achieved by removing services. Every intent that existed before still exists after — what fell was the number of names for each one.

That is not unusual and it is not a sign of a badly run bank. It is the predictable result of a catalogue that can only grow, maintained by people who were individually correct each time they added an entry. The underlying finding is that the bank had always been running roughly five hundred services and describing them six thousand ways.

Five steps, and the order matters — rebuilding from intent before touching any system mapping is what makes the collapse defensible

01
Catalogue what is asked

Sample real contacts across channels and record the customer's intent in their words, not the system's.

02
Cluster by intent

Group by what the customer wants, ignoring which system fulfils it. Duplicates surface immediately at this step.

03
Define the target set

One entry per distinct intent, at a granularity an agent can navigate under time pressure — hundreds, not thousands.

04
Map back to systems

Only now connect each intent to its owning system or systems. One intent may route to several; that is fine.

05
Migrate with a crosswalk

Every old type maps to a new one, so history is preserved and reporting continuity holds across the change.

Why intent before systems

- Starting from the system map reproduces the system boundaries that caused the sprawl.
- Starting from intent produces a set that matches how customers actually ask, which is also how agents search.
- The mapping step is then a translation exercise rather than a design one.

Why the crosswalk is non-negotiable

- Without it, all historical volume becomes uncomparable and the business loses its baseline at exactly the moment it needs one.
- With it, the bank can show the same year on both taxonomies and prove the collapse changed nothing about demand.
- It is also what allows the change to be reversed if something was mis-grouped.

What made it acceptable to the business

- Nobody lost a service. Every intent still exists; only the number of names for it changed.
- Reporting continuity meant no manager lost their numbers.
- Framing it as removing duplicates rather than reducing the catalogue changed the entire conversation.

Source: Author's method analysis of the reference deployment · author's method

One hundred and eighty types were designated resolvable at first touch — which is a design commitment, not a target handed to agents

What first-touch resolution required	Why it is a design decision	What it is not
A stable type with one definition	You cannot resolve at first touch what you cannot reliably identify	Not an agent-effort problem
Authority delegated to the front line	Someone must be permitted to decide without escalating	Not a training initiative
Data visible at the point of contact	The agent needs the answer on screen, not in a second system	Not a knowledge-base project
A template for the response	Two hundred templates exist so the answer is consistent and fast	Not a scripting exercise
A disposition captured once	Resolution must be recorded or it cannot be counted or improved	Not a reporting change
An escalation path that is used	Types that genuinely cannot resolve at first touch must not be forced to	Not a universal target

The mistake this design avoids

First-touch resolution is usually introduced as a performance target — a percentage handed to a contact centre with the expectation that agents will try harder. That produces two behaviours: cases closed that were not resolved, and cases logged under a type that happens to resolve easily.

Designating which types are resolvable at first touch, and building the authority, data and templates to make that true, turns the same measure into a design commitment. The number then reflects how much of the catalogue the bank has actually equipped the front line to handle — which is a statement about the organisation rather than about the agents.

Source: Author's method analysis of the reference deployment · author's analysis

WHAT TRANSFERS

Four rules for a service catalogue that has stopped working

01	**Suspect the catalogue before the process**	Poor turnaround, weak first-touch resolution and failed automation all present as process problems. Where the catalogue has grown to thousands of entries, it is upstream of all three and nothing downstream will hold until it is fixed.
02	**Rebuild from intent, then map to systems**	Starting from the system map reproduces the boundaries that caused the sprawl. Starting from what customers ask produces a set that matches how agents search — and the mapping becomes translation rather than design.
03	**Never break the reporting crosswalk**	Every old type must map to a new one. Without that the business loses its baseline at the moment it most needs one, and the change becomes unprovable and irreversible.
04	**Make first-touch resolution a design commitment**	Handed to a contact centre as a target it produces closed-not-resolved cases and mis-typing. Designated per type, with authority, data and templates behind it, it measures what the organisation has equipped the front line to do.

Six thousand to five hundred and twenty-six sounds like a reduction. It was a correction — the bank had always run about five hundred services and had simply accumulated six thousand ways of describing them.

Source: Author's analysis